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>Subject: New Mexico governor writes controversial foreword to new Roswellbook!
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**>ROSWELL JULY '47 BOMBSHELL: FLYING
SAUCERS IN NEW MEXICO?! GOVERNOR
BILL**

**>RICHARDSON REKINDLES ROSWELL
UFO CRASH BY WRITING FOREWORD IN
NEW**

>ROSWELL EXPOSE BOOK / DEBUNKER/SKEPTIC PHIL KLASS
SAYS "NO EVIDENCE OF

>ET AFTER 33 YEARS OF LOOKING FOR LITTLE GREEN MEN!" / SKEPTICS: "It was
>a special USAF military research balloon!" -

>By [REDACTED] San Francisco Chronicle, Monday, August 16, 2004

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>
>Ten years after the U.S. Air Force closed its books on the claim that a
>UFO crashed in Roswell, N.M., in 1947, a top Democratic Party figure

Wednesday, August 18, 2004 CompuServe: DrSGreer

>wants to reopen the investigation into the cosmic legend.

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>Despite denials by federal officials, many UFO buffs cherish the notion

>that in early summer of 1947, a flying saucer crashed in rural Roswell,

>scattering alien bodies and saucer debris across the terrain.

>

>Now Gov. Bill Richardson of New Mexico, who chaired the recent

>Democratic convention in Boston, says in his foreword to a new book that

>"the mystery surrounding this crash has never been adequately explained

>— not by independent investigators, and not by the U.S. government. ...

>There are as many theories as there are official explanations.

>"Clearly, it would help everyone if the U.S. government disclosed

>everything it knows," says Richardson, who served as Energy secretary

>under President Bill Clinton. "The American people can handle the truth

>— no matter how bizarre or mundane. ... With full disclosure and our

>best scientific investigation, we should be able to find out what

>happened on that fateful day in July 1947."

>

>The passage appears in a paperback titled "The Roswell Dig Diaries,"

>published in collaboration with TV's SciFi Channel by Pocket Books, a

>division of Simon & Schuster. The "dig" of the title refers to an

>archaeological dig at the supposed crash site. A Richardson aide, Billy

>Sparks, confirmed the governor's remarks. Richardson "is interested in

>either debunking the story or (encouraging) full disclosure" of any

>unreleased records on the case, Sparks said.

>

>To the Air Force, though, there is no mystery — and there hasn't been

>for a long time. In 1994, the Air Force published "Roswell Report: Case

>Closed," which asserted that so-called saucer debris was, in fact, the

>ruins of an unusual type of military research balloon, which contained

>hypersensitive acoustic sensors designed to detect the rumble of any

>Soviet A-bomb tests. A subsequent investigation by the U.S. General

>Accounting Office was unable to locate any unreleased records on the

>case.

>Hence, [REDACTED] foreword drew scorn from veteran UFO investigators

>and science popularizers.

>

>"We're kind of disappointed in [REDACTED] for perpetuating the mythology

>of that thing," said Dave Thomas, president of New Mexicans for Science

>and Reason, a skeptics group in Albuquerque.

>

>The grand old man of skeptical UFO investigators, Philip J. Klass, who

>has written for Aviation Week & Space Technology since 1952, said: "Gov.

>[REDACTED] — whom I previously admired — is wrong about Roswell and

>too trusting of TV network promoters. After more than a third of a

>century of research, I have found no credible evidence of

>extraterrestrial visitors."

>

>Andrew Fraknoi, a noted astronomy popularizer and critic of

>pseudoscience who teaches at Foothill College in Los Altos Hills, called

>Richardson's foreword unbelievable.

>

>"This continues to confirm that election or appointment to high office

>does not guarantee wisdom in all areas of human thought," he said.

>

>But in a show of extraterrestrial bipartisanship, the executive director

>of the New Mexico Republican Party is taking Richardson's side. Greg

>Graves, a native of Roswell who suspects the crashed object was

>"something more than a weather balloon," wants to know what really

>happened in the Southwestern desert two years before his birth.

>

>Still,  hopes the truth isn't disillusioning. That's because the
 >saucer legend is so good for the local economy: "Thousands of people
 >come to Roswell every year to visit the site and go to the museum. It's
 >an incredible boon to the Roswell economy. Just think about 'X Files'
 >and TV shows about Roswell.

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 >"When I go around the country and tell people I was born in Roswell," he
 >adds, "people ask: 'Do I think something crashed there?' "

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